NexaPair × KAYAK STRATEGIC ADVISORS

PLAYBOOK



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Third-party incident notification playbook

What to do, and what to send, when an incident at a third party affects a Critical Operation. Supports CBUAE Regulation C 1/2026, Article 15.

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ABOUT THIS PLAYBOOK

Four hours starts when you detect it

When an operational risk event significantly affects a Critical Operation, the first notice to the Central Bank is due within four hours. If a vendor supports that operation, its outage can start your clock.

T0	T+4 h	T+24 h	Recovery	T+72 h
Incident detected	Initial notification	Summary report	Return to normal	High-risk report
Open the log	Part A	Part B	Part C	Part D

How to use it

1. **Agree it in advance.** Share Part A with critical vendors so they know what you will need from them, and how fast.
2. **Use UAE time.** Record every time in Gulf Standard Time.
3. **Send what you know.** An initial notice on time with gaps beats a complete notice late; say when the next update will come.
4. **Keep the log.** The internal log is your evidence of timeliness.

> **CHECK BEFORE USE**
>
> Deadlines here are paraphrased. Confirm the Central Bank's current reporting channel, format and requirements in the CBUAE Rulebook.

ROLES

Incident lead
Runs the response and keeps the log.

Compliance
Sends every notice to the Central Bank.

Vendor owner
Gets the facts from the third party, fast.

Approver
Approves Part A and signs Part D.



Practise the four-hour notice with your critical vendors before you need it. Photo: Pexels.

THE PLAY

From detection to the first notice

Decide quickly whether the clock has started, then work back from four hours. The targets below are suggested internal times, not regulatory deadlines.



T0 to 15 min — **Open the log**
Incident lead records the time of detection and the source; names the vendor owner.

By 30 min — **Classify**
Check the Critical Operations map: is a Critical Operation affected, and how far from its tolerance?

By 1 h — **Confirm with the vendor**
Vendor owner gets scope, start time, cause if known and expected recovery from the third party.

By 3 h — **Draft Part A**
Compliance drafts the notice from the log; gaps are stated, with the time of the next update.

By 4 h — **Approve and send**
Approver signs off; Compliance sends Part A and records the time sent.

Then — **Keep the clock**
Summary within 24 h, return-to-normal notice on recovery, high-risk report within 72 h.

QUESTIONS TO START WITH

01 Can every critical vendor reach your incident lead within the hour, day or night?

02 Does your Critical Operations map show which vendors sit behind each operation?

03 Who approves Part A if the usual approver cannot be reached?

04 When did you last rehearse the four-hour notice with a vendor?

A Initial notification

within 4 hours

Institution name and licence number	
Person reporting: name, role, phone, email	
Date and time the incident was detected Use UAE time (GST).	
Date and time of this notification	
Third party involved	
Critical Operation(s) affected	
What happened, in brief	
Current impact on customers and services	
Immediate actions taken	
Information not yet known Say what is missing and when you expect it.	
Next update expected at	

B Summary report

within 24 hours

Timeline of events so far	
Root cause, if known	
Customers, transactions and data affected Numbers if known	
Financial impact estimate	
Has customer data been compromised?	☐ No ☐ Suspected ☐ Confirmed
Recovery actions and expected recovery time	
Communications to customers and other authorities	

C Return to normal

on recovery

Date and time normal operations resumed	
Confirmation from the third party	
Residual issues being monitored	

BEFORE YOU SEND PART B

Confirm every figure with the third party in writing, and note in the log where each number came from.

BEFORE YOU SEND PART C

Get the third party's written confirmation that service is restored, and keep watching for repeat failures.

D **High-risk incident report**	within 72 hours
Why the incident is classified as high risk Apply your Board-approved criteria.	
Full root-cause analysis	
Lessons learned and control improvements	
Changes to the third-party arrangement For example remediation plan, enhanced monitoring, exit.	
Approved by: name, role, date	

Internal log: evidence of timeliness

Step	Due	Owner	Done at (GST)
Incident confirmed with the third party	T+1 h		
Initial notification sent to the Central Bank	T+4 h		
Summary report sent	T+24 h		
Return-to-normal notice sent	On recovery		
High-risk report sent (if applicable)	T+72 h		

BE READY BEFORE IT HAPPENS

Contact sheet

Fill this in before you need it, and check it every quarter. Include a deputy for every role.

Role	Name	Deputy	Phone	Email
Incident lead				
Compliance (Central Bank notices)				
Vendor owner				
Third-party incident contact				
Approver (Part D)				
Communications				

4 h
initial notice from detection

24 h
summary report

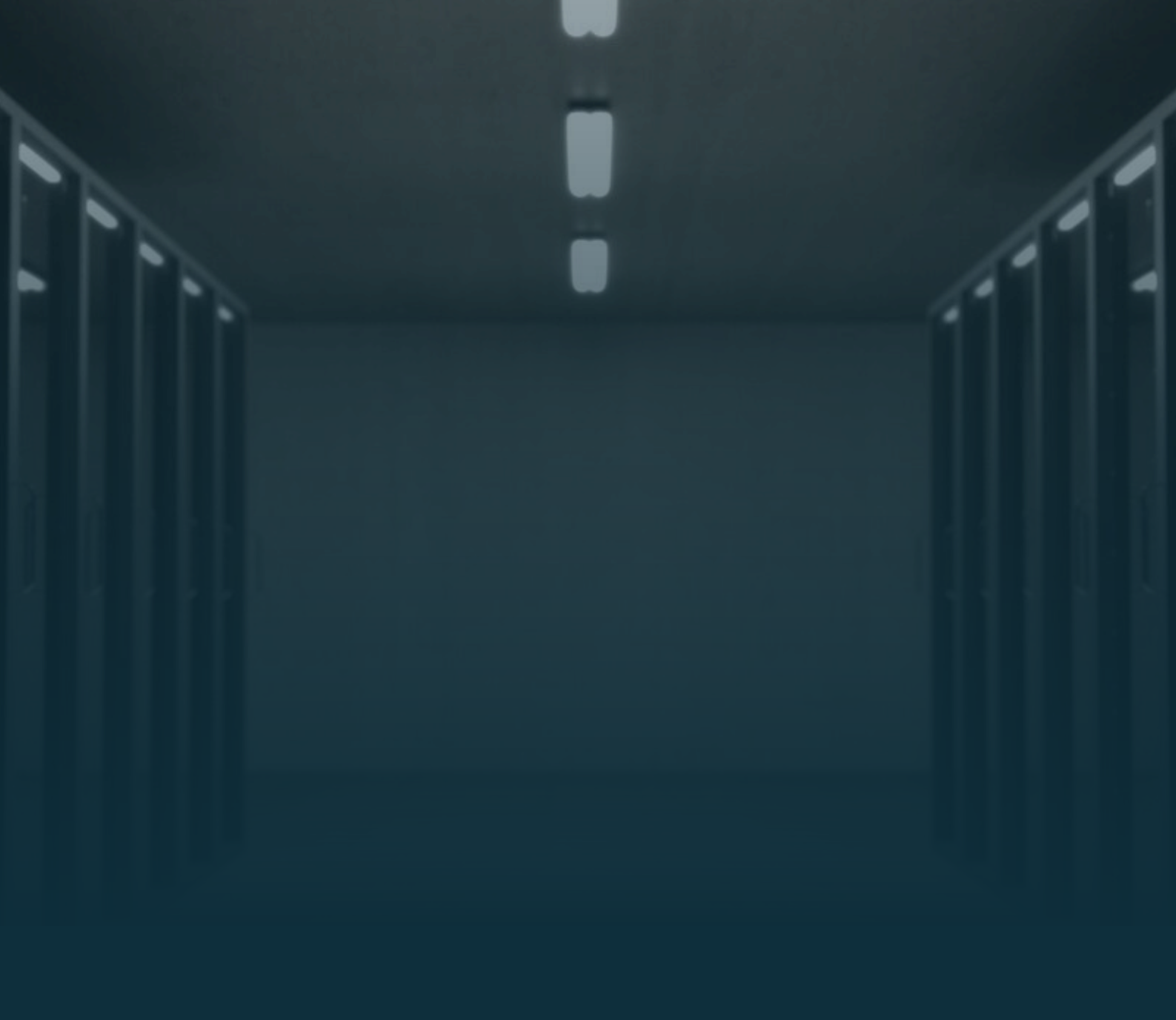
72 h
high-risk incident report

REHEARSE IT

Run a drill with one critical vendor each quarter: start the clock, draft Part A from what you learn in the first hour, and time each step. File the drill record with this playbook.

DO IT IN NEXAPAIR

NexaSentinel starts the clock when a vendor incident is logged, drafts each notice from the record in this format and keeps the time-stamped trail.



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ABOUT NEXAPAIR

NexaPair is a third-party risk management platform for the UAE, hosted in a UAE cloud region. It verifies, screens, monitors and scores the companies an institution depends on, and keeps the evidence a regulator expects.

ABOUT KAYAK STRATEGIC ADVISORS

Kayak Strategic Advisors Private Limited (CIN U70200MH2026PTC477060) is a management consultancy based in Mumbai. It builds and runs NexaPair, pairing advisory judgement with software.

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